LESS LAPTOP, MORE FREEDOM

HP OmniPad 12 offers in-between versatility

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Whether it's packing it in your college backpack or work-related trolley bag, inevitably there comes a point when your laptop starts to feel less like a productivity tool. Apart from the tiny college desk or airport security tray, your laptop feels more like luggage when all you really use it for is Chrome, Google Docs, email, and video calls.

That is precisely where the HP OmniPad 12 tries to enter the conversation. HP calls it a "laptop meets tablet" device: a 12-inch 2K touchscreen, detachable full-size keyboard, 8GB LPDDR5 memory and Snapdragon SM6475Q platform, all powered by Android 16 OS. Two variants exist with 128GB and 256GB configurations, at Rs 48,999 and Rs 54,999, respectively.

The question OmniPad 12 needs to answer is whether it can disappear into a workday so well that you stop wishing you lugged around a "proper" laptop.

Changes how you pack

Compared to the MacBook Air M2, side by side, you start to appreciate the OmniPad 12's smaller and lighter form factor – it's easy to tuck away in your backpack or even your handbag, no problem whatsoever.

That portability is thanks largely to the tablet itself weighing about 600g. Add the detachable keyboard and the package creeps close to conventional thin-and-light territory, but you do not have to carry the whole package everywhere. Pull off the keyboard and it becomes a reading, browsing or video device. Snap it back on and it returns to desktop duty as an ultraportable laptop.

The overall build quality of the tablet feels premium. The metal-backed tablet feels more substantial than the "budget laptop alternative" label suggests. The 12-inch 2000x1200 display runs at up to 90Hz, covers 100 percent sRGB according to HP, and gives you enough room for documents, tabs and presentations without feeling amateurish.

Typing on the bundled keypad case of the OmniPad 12 feels solid. The keys have adequate dip and travel for tactile feedback, and the trackpad is good enough for single or multi-finger input. I like the screen cover which has a bendable flap design, allowing you to adjust the screen's angle in laptop typing mode. The flap is very well built, doesn't feel flimsy at all, and grounds the screen with reassurance no matter how steep the angle is.

That keyboard matters more than any benchmark on the OmniPad 12. Desk mode also makes Android behave more like a familiar desktop environment, with windowing and laptop-style multitasking. HP explicitly positions Android 16's desktop windowing as a productivity feature, and the transition between touch-first tablet use and keyboard-first work is the OmniPad's smartest trick. Crucially, it never feels like something you need to learn, because it's very intuitive.

Versatility over performance

Expectations need calibration on the HP OmniPad 12, because it's not the fastest, nor does it claim to be. The